Basic bidding Notrump raises Major suit raises

This set of practice deals focuses on basic bidding situations. There are no conventions used except for one deal which uses Blackwood. Even that is optional.

The deals are designed with the beginning player in mind, or perhaps those who feel the need to refresh themselves on the fundamentals of bidding.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in finding a fit and deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam.

Keep in mind:
- a combined 8-card trump fit is desired to play in a suit
- it takes 26 points to make game in Notrump or a Major suit
- it takes 33 points to make small slam

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠2

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣5

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: South
Lead: ♥K

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 1NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♠7

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 2♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥8

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A Q 10 6
♥ 5 4
♦ A 8 7 4
♣ A 8 2

♠ 9 7 5 3
♥ 10 9 8
♦ K Q 9 3
♣ J 5



♠ 2
♥ Q J 6 3
♦ J 10 2
♣ Q 10 7 6 4

♠ K J 8 4
♥ A K 7 2
♦ 6 5
♣ K 9 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♦	Pass	1♥
Pass	1♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♠2

With two 4-card Majors SOUTH should respond "up-the-line", bidding ♥s first.

Then, after NORTH bids 1♠, SOUTH has enough points to jump all the way to 4♠.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ J 7 5
♥ K 9 8 3
♦ 10 4
♣ A K 4 2

♠ A 9 6 3
♥ Q 6 4
♦ A 9 6 2
♣ J 7



♠ K Q 10 8 4
♥ A 7
♦ K Q 5
♣ Q 10 6

♠ 2
♥ J 10 5 2
♦ J 8 7 3
♣ 9 8 5 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♠	Pass
3♠	Pass	4♠	
All Pass			

4♠ by East
Lead: ♣5

EAST has 17 points and might open 1NT. But with the 5-card Major suit she prefers to open 1♠.

WEST has excellent ♠ support but with 11 points is not quite strong enough to insist on reaching game. Instead he makes an invitational jump to 3♠, which EAST is strong enough to raise to game.

Board 3
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ 8 7 ♥ 10 6 4 ♦ K Q 10 9 6 ♣ 10 7 3	
♠ 10 9 3 ♥ K Q 7 5 2 ♦ 5 3 ♣ Q 6 4	N W E S	♠ Q J 5 4 2 ♥ 8 3 ♦ 8 7 4 ♣ K J 9
	♠ A K 6 ♥ A J 9 ♦ A J 2 ♣ A 8 5 2	

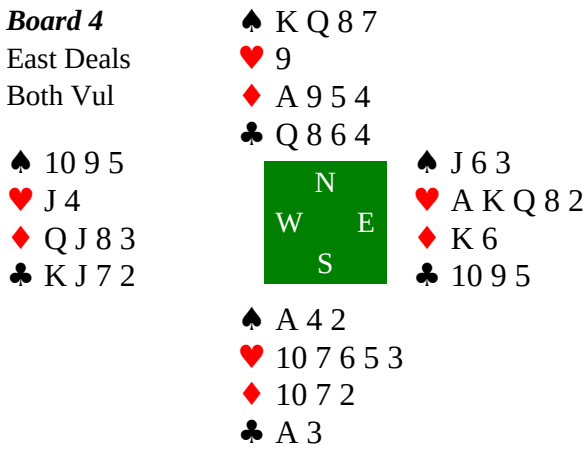
West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by South
Lead: ♥K

SOUTH has a powerful hand, but 21 points is not strong enough to start with a forcing 2♣ bid. Since he has balanced distribution he opens 2NT (20-21 points).

NORTH adds her 6 points to SOUTH's minimum and concludes they should be in game. She expects her good ♦ suit to be useful to NORTH in Notrump so she bids 3NT.

Board 4
East Deals
Both Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♥	Pass
1NT			
All Pass			

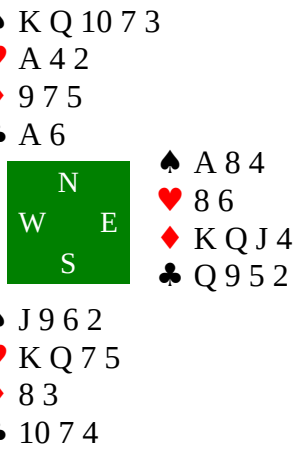
1NT by West
Lead: ♠7

EAST has a solid 1♥ opening, 14 points and five trumps.

WEST must respond with 8 points, but cannot bid either minor suit since he needs at least 11 points to bid a new suit at the 2-level. So he bids 1NT (6-10 points).

EAST doesn't object to Notrump so she passes.

Board 5
North Deals
N-S Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♠	Pass	2♠
All Pass			

2♠ by North
Lead: ♥8

NORTH has a normal 1♠ opening bid, 14 points and five trumps.

SOUTH has good 4-card support and 7 points, so she raises to 2♠, passed by NORTH.

SOUTH does not consider showing the ♥s, first because she knows there is a ♠ fit, and second because she doesn't have the 11 points needed to bid a new suit at the 2-level.